

JACOB AFO

Business Development Manager · Product Strategy · Applied AI in Financial Services

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PROFILE

Business and technology leader with 7+ years building distribution models, digital products and data-led growth strategy across Nigeria's banking and fintech sector. Currently leads regional agent and merchant business development at Redtech Limited, after four years scaling First Bank of Nigeria's agent network past 57,000 active agents and managing a ₦5–6 billion portfolio. Beginning an MSc in Artificial Intelligence at Ulster University in September 2026 to pair that track record with technical depth, building financial products that widen access and create economic opportunity in emerging markets.

CORE STRENGTHS

Business Development & Channel Growth · Product Strategy & Roadmapping · Financial Inclusion & Digital Banking · Data-Driven Decision Making (Power BI, Excel, SQL) · Applied AI in Financial Services · Cross-Functional & Team Leadership

57,000+ Active agents supported	9,975+ Agents onboarded in one year	₦5–6B Portfolio managed
20% Growth in transaction value	40% Faster onboarding & activation	7+ Years in banking & digital finance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business Development Manager — Redtech Limited May 2026 – Present

Leads regional agent and merchant business development, driving team productivity and transaction growth while ensuring regulatory and operational compliance.

- Directs merchant and agent acquisition, engagement and terminal deployment across the region
- Sets and drives regional sales targets, accelerating transaction volume and value
- Owns regulatory and operational compliance across all regional field operations

Regional Product Manager – Agent & Merchant Business — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. Jan 2024 – May 2026

- Onboarded 9,975 new agents in one year, growing the active agent base to 57,000 and strengthening coverage in underserved regions
- Improved average transaction value by ~20% through payment flow optimisation and targeted agent enablement
- Designed activation programmes that lifted monthly active agent rates by 15–20%, improving network reliability and revenue stability
- Partnered with engineering, compliance, operations and marketing to deliver scalable, compliant digital solutions
- Cut onboarding and activation timelines by ~40% through process redesign and standardisation

Regional Product Manager – E-Business & Retail Products — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. Feb 2023 – Jan 2024

- Owned the product roadmap for mobile and agent banking platforms supporting 57,000 agents nationwide
- Partnered with engineering, data and UX teams to improve customer and agent journeys, delivering 14% year-on-year growth in active transacting agents
- Converted market and competitor analysis across fintech and bank-led platforms into product enhancements that lifted usage by 5–8%
- Sustained transaction growth through economic volatility by prioritising high-impact initiatives

Business Relationship Manager – Retail Banking — First Bank of Nigeria Ltd. Jun 2019 – Feb 2023

- Managed a ₦5–6 billion retail and SME portfolio, delivering 10–15% growth through structured relationship strategies
- Used customer and transaction data to identify growth opportunities and expand share of wallet
- Acted as the link between customers, product teams and operations, improving service turnaround times by ~25%
- Maintained full KYC/AML compliance with zero audit or regulatory issues

Trade Developer — kimberly Ryan Limited. Jan 2018 – April 2019

- Managed FirstMonie agent acquisition and activation.
- Strengthened agent engagement and business performance.
- Supported financial inclusion initiatives.

EDUCATION

MSc, Artificial Intelligence — Ulster University, Belfast Starting September 2026

MSc, Information Technology — National Open University of Nigeria 2023

BSc, Computer Science — Cross River University of Technology, Nigeria 2016

CERTIFICATIONS & AFFILIATIONS

Data Analytics for Strategic Decision Making — CIBN, 2025
Associate, Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria (ACIB), 2023
Business Intelligence & Data Analytics — Corporate Finance Institute, 2022